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Protect Amazon API Applications with Data Retention and Recovery

GET STARTED

Welcome to SP-API Documentation

What is the Selling Partner API?

Selling Partner API Onboarding Overview

Terminology

Frequently Asked Questions

Protect Amazon API Applications with Data Retention and Recovery

Data retention and recovery procedures to help ensure access to data and reduce data exposure.

Different data types require various retention times, which complicates the balance of keeping data readily available for use and also maintaining legal, business, and personal requirements. Establishing data retention and recovery procedures helps ensure access to data, such as personally identifiable information (PII), is available for as long as required to operate the business while simultaneously reducing the risk of data exposure.

To learn more about the terms that are used on this page, use the mouseover definitions or refer to the [Terminology](#) page.

Data protection policy requirements

As stated in the [Amazon Services API Data Protection Policy](#):

Developers will retain PII for no longer than 30 days after order delivery and only for the purpose of, and as long as is necessary to (i) fulfill orders, (ii) calculate and remit taxes, (iii) produce tax invoices and other legally required documents, and (iv) meet legal requirements, including tax or regulatory requirements. Developers can retain data for more than 30 days after order delivery only if required by law and only for the purposes of complying with that law. Per sections 1.5 ("Encryption in Transit") and 2.4 ("Encryption at Rest") at no point should PII be transmitted or stored unprotected.

Foundation of data retention and recovery

Keeping Amazon customer PII private is important to ensure the integrity of the buyer's identity. This type of information requires protection because it can be used for unsolicited marketing, to commit fraud, or to steal an individual's identity. Deleting content that is no longer needed reduces the risk of litigation and security breaches.

CHANGELOG

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DIRECTORIES

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SP-API Seller Use Cases

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Seller Central URLs

Vendor Central URLs

REGISTRATION

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Third-Party Provider Registration

Service Provider Registration and Role Approval Process Overview

Website Guidelines for Public Developers and Service Providers

User Permissions for Service Providers

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Update your Application Information

Rotate your Application's LWA Credentials

View your Application Information and Credentials

Learn How Sellers Authorize Service Providers

Selling Partner API Roles

Policies and Agreements

About Facial Data

AUTHORIZATION

Authorize Applications

>

Developers can leverage NIST-800-53 control **SI-12: Information Management and Retention**. The intent of this control is to ensure that information, including PII, is retained in accordance with regulatory, contractual, and business requirements.

Renew Authorizations

Revoke Authorizations

Authorization Limits

Special Authorization Types

>

Developers should also consider all applicable requirements. These requirements determine the data retention period, including cases beyond system disposal. Developers can still obtain historical information as needed to fulfill their obligations by contacting Developer Support.

INTEGRATION

Building Robust Amazon SP-API Applications

SP-API SDKs

>

Data collection

Before collecting Amazon customer PII, an organization must determine two things:

- The business need for customer PII.
- Who should have access to the data.

Developer requirements for Amazon customer PII must comply with the [Amazon Services API Data Protection Policy](#).

Developers are required to retain Amazon customer PII only for as long as it is necessary to fulfill orders or to calculate/remit taxes on behalf of sellers. Amazon customer PII should not be stored in developer systems for longer than 30 days after order shipment.

Delete an Application From Your Developer Account

CALLING THE SP-API

Configuration Details	>	If a developer is required by law to retain copies of Amazon customer PII for tax, legal, or similar regulatory purposes, this Amazon information can be stored in a cold, or offline, backup store in a physically secure facility.
Call Structure	>	
Development Tools	>	All data archived on backup media must be encrypted. This traditionally requires expensive, purpose-built hardware and can quickly raise storage costs as the volume of data retention increases. Using cloud storage such as Amazon Simple Storage Service Glacier (Amazon S3 Glacier) for long-term archiving allows organizations to store data cost-effectively for years or even decades. With this approach organizations can offload the administrative task of managing and scaling storage.
Performance Management	>	
SOLUTION PROVIDER PORTAL		
Manage Users in Solution Provider Portal		
Manage Your Business And Contact information in Solution Provider Portal		
Update Your Developer Profile in Solution Provider Portal		
Unify Your Developer Accounts		
Verify Your Identity in Solution Provider Portal		
API Usage Metrics in Solution Provider Portal		

TUTORIALS

Tutorial: Subscribe to the ORDER_CHANGE Notification		
Tutorial: Test Selling Partner API Endpoints		
Tutorial: Automate your SP-API Calls Using a C# SDK		
Tutorial: Automate your SP-API Calls Using a Java SDK		
Tutorial: Automate your SP-API Calls Using a JavaScript SDK for Node.js		
Tutorial: Automate your SP-API Calls Using a Python SDK		
Tutorial: Automate your SP-API Calls using a prebuilt C# SDK		
Tutorial: Automate your SP-API Calls using prebuilt Java SDK		
Tutorial: Automate your SP-API Calls using a prebuilt JavaScript SDK		

If use of cold storage is not in line with business use cases and data must remain in production, developers must ensure that PII information obtained through SP-API that is retained and transmitted through developer systems is encrypted at all times.

Developers must also ensure that only authorized personnel have access to this data. Refer to [Protecting Amazon API Applications: Data Encryption](#) for more information about encryption.

Tutorial: Automate your SP-API Calls using prebuilt PHP SDK

Tutorial: Automate your SP-API calls using a prebuilt Python SDK

Tutorial: Authorize Multiple Vendor Central Accounts with a Single SP-API Application

Tutorial: Retrieve Merchant Shipping Templates

Tutorial: Grant the SP-API Permission to an Amazon SQS Queue

Tutorial: Retrieve and Pass a Purchase Order Number to a Carrier



TROUBLESHOOTING

Troubleshoot SP-API Errors

URL Encoding

Resolve Common HTTP and Authorization Error Codes

External Fulfillment Errors



Listings Items API Issues Troubleshooting



SELLING PARTNER APPSTORE

What is the Selling Partner Appstore?

List Your App on the Selling Partner Appstore

Edit Your Appstore Listing

Check Listing Status

Appstore Ratings and Reviews

Press Releases and Promotions

SERVICE PROVIDER NETWORK

List Your Service

SECURITY AND COMPLIANCE

SP-API Security and Compliance Overview

Amazon Selling Partner API Guard Implementation Guide



Retention

When creating or revising a data retention plan developers must:

- **Create a data retention policy.** This policy must comply with the Amazon Data Protection Policy and should meet the developer's legal requirements.
- **Automate data retention tasks.** This should be done in such a way that tasks can be easily changed as requirements change. Amazon S3 Glacier is an example of a cloud-based archive that can automatically archive data based on a policy. For more information about Amazon S3 Glacier, refer to the [Archiving](#) section.
- **Consider whether data should be archived or deleted.** Deletion is permanent, but archiving incurs running costs. Implement different lifecycles for different data types and use cases. For example, fulfillment has different legal and business requirements than tax use cases.

VAT Calculation Service >

Amazon Seller Data Access

Best Practices >

Key Security Control Guidance

Logging and Monitoring for Amazon SP-API Applications

Network Protection Guidance

Protect Amazon API Applications with Data Encryption

Protect Amazon API Applications with Data Retention and Recovery

Protect Amazon SP-API Applications with Incident Response

Safeguarding Sensitive Credentials

Vulnerability Management

A+ CONTENT API

A+ Content API >

A+ Content Examples

AMAZON WAREHOUSING AND DISTRIBUTION API

Amazon Warehousing and Distribution API >

- **Delete Amazon information** when it is no longer necessary or no longer subject to other retention obligations.
- **Keep Amazon sellers informed** about data retention practices you follow and the basis on which sellers must access and process Amazon customer PII.
- **Back up and secure Amazon information at all times.** This must be done in accordance with SP-API policies. This is important for data retention and data management in general.

Archiving

When there is a need to preserve Amazon information for compliance or regulatory reasons, developers should archive information whenever possible. Unlike creating a backup, which is keeping a copy of production data for a short time to recover from data corruption or loss, archiving maintains all copies of the data until the retention policy expires.

A good archive system has the following features:

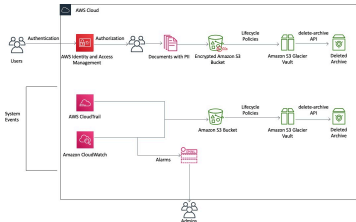
- Data durability for long-term integrity
- Data security
- Ease of recoverability
- Low cost

7/4/26, 12:55 PM		Protect Amazon API Applications with Data Retention and Recovery	
Amazon Warehousing and Distribution API v2024-05-09 Reference			
APP INTEGRATIONS API			
App Integrations API	>	Developers using NIST 800-53 as their framework can refer to control MP-4: Media Storage. Although this control is part of the Media Protection (MP) domain and SP-API developers should archive and store archived information in a cold, or offline, back-up housed in a physically secured facility. MP-4 specifically requires protection of media by physically controlling and securely storing media, as well disposing of media correctly. Developers can further enhance this control by implementing cryptographic protection as outlined in SC-28(1). Consider leveraging cold storage options on public clouds to meet the requirements of this control. Archiving data with Amazon Web Services (AWS) Amazon Simple Storage Service Glacier (Amazon S3 Glacier) is a secure, durable, and low-cost solution for data archiving and long-term backup. Additionally, it provides native encryption of data at rest, 99.999999999% (11 nines) of durability, and unlimited capacity. Amazon S3 Glacier customers can store data for as little as \$1 per terabyte per month. Amazon S3 Glacier also provides three options for access to archives, with retrieval times ranging from	
APPLICATION MANAGEMENT API			
Application Management API	>		
CATALOG ITEMS API			
Catalog Items API	>		
Catalog Items API Rate Limits			
Catalog Items API v2022-04-01 Reference			
CUSTOMER FEEDBACK API			
Customer Feedback API	>	Archiving data with Amazon Web Services (AWS) Amazon Simple Storage Service Glacier (Amazon S3 Glacier) is a secure, durable, and low-cost solution for data archiving and long-term backup. Additionally, it provides native encryption of data at rest, 99.999999999% (11 nines) of durability, and unlimited capacity. Amazon S3 Glacier customers can store data for as little as \$1 per terabyte per month. Amazon S3 Glacier also provides three options for access to archives, with retrieval times ranging from	
Customer Feedback API Rate Limits			
DATA KIOSK			
Data Kiosk API	>		
Data Kiosk Schema Explorer User Guide			
Data Kiosk Query Processing Finished Notification			
Building Data Kiosk workflows guide			
Vendor Analytics Dataset Use Case Guide			
Schedule Data Kiosk Queries			
DELIVERY BY AMAZON API			

<https://developer-docs.amazon/sp-api/docs/protecting-amazon-api-applications-data-encryption-and-recovery>

7/18

Delivery by Amazon API	>	milliseconds, to a few minutes, to several hours.
		Amazon S3 Standard-Infrequent Access is a good choice for use cases that require quick retrieval of data. Amazon S3 Glacier is a good choice for use cases where data is infrequently accessed and retrieval times of several hours are acceptable.
EASY SHIP API		
Easy Ship API	>	Objects are tiered into Amazon S3 Glacier either through lifecycle rules in Simple Storage Service (Amazon S3) or the Amazon S3 Glacier Vault Lock feature allows users to easily deploy and enforce compliance controls for individual Amazon Glacier vaults with a vault lock policy. Developers can specify controls such as <i>write-once-read-many</i> (WORM) in a vault lock policy and lock the policy from future edits.
EXTERNAL FULFILLMENT		
External Fulfillment Inventory API	>	Here is a visual representation of how AWS products can be used to satisfy data retention and recovery requirements:
External Fulfillment Returns API	>	
External Fulfillment Shipping API	>	
External Fulfillment Errors		
External Fulfillment APIs Rate Limits		
FULFILLMENT BY AMAZON (FBA)		
FBA Inventory API	>	
FBA Inventory Dynamic Sandbox Guide		
FEEDS API		
Feeds API	>	
Feed Type Values	>	



Feeds JSON Schemas

Feeds API Best Practices

Feeds API FAQ

Feeds API Rate Limits

FINANCES

Finances API



then be used to automatically shift data from the Amazon S3 bucket into an Amazon S3 Glacier vault. After information is no longer required for regulatory purposes, the Amazon S3 Glacier delete-archive API is called to delete the information.



Additionally, AWS CloudTrail and AWS CloudWatch are enabled to log actions in the environment and notify administrators via email if an event occurs. The logs, stored in Amazon S3 buckets, are also subject to lifecycle policies. This helps to eliminate unnecessary storage costs.

Transfers API



FULFILLMENT INBOUND API

Fulfillment Inbound API



For more information, refer to [What is Amazon S3 Glacier](#) and [Set Up a Compliant Archive](#).

Hybrid scenario

This section is for developers who use a large hybrid environment. Let's say a developer is managing an environment used to back up Amazon EC2 instances, standalone servers, virtual machines, and databases.

Fulfillment Inbound API FAQ

Migrating Fulfillment Inbound workflows

Fulfillment Inbound API Rate Limits

FULFILLMENT OUTBOUND API

Fulfillment Outbound Dynamic Sandbox Guide

Fulfillment Outbound API



This environment has 1,000 servers. The operating system, file data, virtual machine images, and databases are backed up. There are 20 databases (a mixture of MySQL, Microsoft SQL Server, and Oracle) to back up. The backup software has agents that back up operating systems, virtual machine images, data

volumes, SQL Server databases, and Oracle databases (using RMAN).

For applications like MySQL for which the backup software does not have an agent, the mysqldump client utility can be used to create a database dump file to disk. The standard backup agents can then protect the data.

To protect this environment, the third-party backup software in use might have a global catalog server or a master server that controls the backup, archive, and restore activities as well as multiple media servers. This server can be connected to disk-based storage, Linear Tape-Open (LTO) tape drives, and AWS storage services.

To augment this backup solution with AWS storage services, developers should consider using a backup vendor that uses Amazon S3 or Amazon S3 Glacier. Amazon suggests working with vendors to understand their integration and connector options. For a list of backup software vendors who work with AWS, refer to the [AWS partner directory](#).

If the existing backup software does not natively support cloud storage for backup or archive, you can use a storage gateway device. This storage gateway acts as a bridge between the backup software and Amazon S3 or Amazon S3 Glacier. There are many third-party gateway

Fulfillment Outbound API Rate Limits

MCF Best Practices

INVOICING

Invoices API

>

Invoices API FAQ

LISTINGS

Listings Items API

>

solutions available to bridge between the two storage mediums, refer to the [AWS partner directory](#).

If you decide to go with an AWS solution, AWS Storage Gateway virtual appliances is one example of such a solution used to bridge this gap because it uses generic techniques such as iSCSI-based volumes and virtual tape libraries (VTLs). This configuration requires a supported hypervisor (VMware or Microsoft Hyper-V) and local storage to host the appliance.

Destruction

To properly delete data, developers must delete it from live data stores as well as any backups or other copies. This means that developers must set up an appropriate retention mechanism on these additional backups and copies that is in line with their business purpose. **Data anonymization is not considered an acceptable method for Amazon information deletion.** For example, hashing Amazon customer PII to anonymize it in data stores is not an acceptable alternative to deleting Amazon information.

Amazon data destruction criteria

This section discusses the minimum criteria Amazon

Listings Items API Rate Limits

Listings Restrictions API

>

Listings Restrictions API Rate Limits

Manage Product Listings with the Selling Partner API

Building Listings Management Workflows Guide

Understanding Amazon listing status and seller-fulfilled inventory management

Listings Management Workflow Migration

>

Manage Amazon Haul, Advanced Multiple-Offer, and Multiple-Fulfillment Use Cases

Listings APIs FAQ

Product Type Definitions API

>

Product Type Definitions API Rate Limits

MERCHANT FULFILLMENT API

Merchant Fulfillment API

>

requires for data to be considered securely deleted.

Case 1 – Directly managing data

To stay consistent with industry standards when directly managing data (for example, storing data on an instance instead of using cloud service for persistent storage), developers must do the following three things to ensure data is deleted securely:

- Ensure that the data is not recoverable by the customer. This includes via an API or other existing mechanisms that can be used to access the data.
- Logically disassociate the data (for example, through removing pointers or unlinking index files (inodes) to data). This action commonly overlaps with the first criteria.
- Mark the media space that contains the deleted data that will be reallocated by the service.

Case 2 – Using a cloud service

When using a service such as Amazon S3 or [Amazon DynamoDB](#) for managing data, the service must call a supported delete mechanism of the service in which it stores data. This can be accomplished by using a “delete” API or by

MESSAGING API

Messaging API >

NOTIFICATIONS API

Notifications API >

Notification Type Values

Tutorial: Subscribe to the ORDER_CHANGE Notification ↗

ORDERS API

Orders API >

Tutorial: Retrieve and Pass a Purchase Order Number to a Carrier ↗

Orders API Migration Guide

Orders API Rate Limits

PRODUCT FEES API

Product Fees API >

implementing a “time to live” mechanism.

Removing pointers to Amazon S3 objects and orphaning data in the service account are not acceptable delete actions.

PRODUCT PRICING API

Product Pricing API

>

Product Pricing API and Notifications FAQ

Price Adjustment Automation Workflows Guide

Manage automated pricing rules with SP-API

REPLENISHMENT API

Replenishment API

>

Acceptable methods for destruction of Amazon data

This section provides an overview of acceptable methods for destroying Amazon data.

- **Clear:** This operation renders data on a device unreadable through “keyboard attacks,” meaning a user using forensic applications but not laboratory techniques. A clear operation might involve one or more overwrite passes of the device, firmware erase commands, or other methods as defined in [NIST SP800-88r1](#).
- **Purge:** This operation renders data on a device unreadable through laboratory recovery techniques. A purge operation might involve advanced firmware erase commands, key scrambling on self-encrypting drives, or other methods as defined in [NIST SP800-88r1](#).

REPORTS API

Reports API

>

Report Type Values

>

		• Physical Destruction: This category, as described in the following subsections, might include crushing, pulverizing, shredding, incinerating, and degaussing. It renders data on the device unrecoverable and the device itself unusable.
Reports JSON Schemas	↗	
Reports API FAQ		
SALES API		
Sales API	>	
SELLER WALLET API		
Seller Wallet API	>	• Degaussing: Applies a magnetic field with strength sufficient to overcome the magnetic coercivity of magnetic media. This is only effective on magnetic media, and the coercivity of media varies between models and manufacturers. Developers should get information directly from the manufacturer to properly calibrate a degausser for a given device.
Seller Wallet API Rate Limits		
SELLERS API		
Sellers API	>	
SERVICES API		
Services API	>	• Crushing: Applying a large compressive force to a device to destroy it. • Pulverizing: Reducing a device to small particles. • Shredding: Cutting media into small parts that cannot be re-assembled. For maximum effectiveness, the cut parts should be smaller than the physical area required to store a block of data. • Incinerating: Applying extreme heat to a device in order to destroy it through burning or
SHIPMENT INVOICING API		
Shipment Invoicing API	>	
SHIPPING API		
Shipping API v2 Resources	↗	

Shipping API v1 Reference

SOLICITATIONS API

Solicitations API

>

melting. Heating past the Curie point of magnetic media (the maximum temperature a material can reach before losing or changing its magnetic properties) is also effective.

SUPPLY SOURCES API

Supply Sources API

>

Conclusion

Data lifecycle management is an important part of securing data. All data, especially PII, must have defined terms around storage length, usage, and destruction. Practicing good data hygiene through retaining and maintaining data for as long as it's needed and destroying when it is not needed, helps to limit the blast radius or amount of data exposed during a security incident. Some authorities and regulatory bodies will have defined standards on how long an organization should retain data, but even without these standards, you should still define how long data is retained. As it so happens similarly with other assets, the longer you keep data around "just in case" it's needed, the more costs associated with storage mediums, locations to store it, and training personnel on proper handling, will increase.

Multi-Location Inventory Integration Guide

Supply Sources API Rate Limits

TOKENS API

Tokens API

>

UPLOADS API

Uploads API

>

VEHICLES API

Vehicles API

>

Vehicles API Rate Limits

VENDOR DIRECT FULFILLMENT APIS

Vendor Direct Fulfillment Dynamic Sandbox Guide

Vendor Direct Fulfillment Workflow Guide

Additional resources

- [Amazon S3 Glacier Developer Guide](#)

SP-API Bill-to-Party Addresses

- [Setting Up a Compliant Archive on AWS](#)

VENDOR DIRECT FULFILLMENT TRANSACTION STATUS API

- [Engage with AWS Partners - Find an AWS APN partner](#)

Vendor Direct Fulfillment Transaction Status API >

- [SP-API Data Protection Policy](#)

VENDOR DIRECT FULFILLMENT INVENTORY API

- [SP-API Acceptable Use Policy](#)

Vendor Direct Fulfillment Inventory API >

VENDOR DIRECT FULFILLMENT ORDERS API

Industry references

- [NIST Special Publication 800-88 Revision 1: Guidelines for Media Sanitization](#)

Vendor Direct Fulfillment Orders API >

- [NIST 800-53 Rev.5: Security and Privacy Controls for Information Systems and Organizations](#)

VENDOR DIRECT FULFILLMENT SHIPPING API

Vendor Direct Fulfillment Shipping API >

Document revisions

Date	Description
December 2022	Revised for technical accuracy
January 2020	First publication

VENDOR DIRECT FULFILLMENT PAYMENTS API

Vendor Direct Fulfillment Payments API >

Notices

Amazon sellers and developers are responsible for making their own independent assessment of the information in this document. This document:

- (a) is for informational purposes only, (b) represents current practices, which are subject to change without

VENDOR RETAIL PROCUREMENT INVOICES API

Vendor Retail Procurement Invoices API >

VENDOR RETAIL PROCUREMENT ORDERS API

Vendor Retail Procurement Orders API



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VENDOR RETAIL PROCUREMENT SHIPMENTS API

Vendor Retail Procurement Shipments API



VENDOR RETAIL PROCUREMENT TRANSACTION STATUS API

Vendor Retail Procurement Transaction Status API



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